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Front Matter
Source: *Public Health Reports (1896-1970)*, Vol. 63, No. 36, Tuberculosis Control Issue No. 31 (Sep. 3, 1948), pp. I-1180
Published by: Association of Schools of Public Health
Stable URL: http://www.jstor.org/stable/4586683
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Public Health Reports

VOLUME 63 SEPTEMBER 3, 1948 NUMBER 36

TUBERCULOSIS CONTROL ISSUE NO. 31

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Tuberculosis Deaths in U. S. by County, 1946

A Streptomycin-Enhanced Strain of *M. Tuberculosis*

Courses in Laboratory Diagnosis of Tuberculosis

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* This is the thirty-first of a series of special issues of PUBLIC HEALTH REPORTS devoted exclusively to tuberculosis control, which will appear the first week of each month. The series began with the Mar. 1, 1946, issue. The articles in these special issues are reprinted as extracts from the PUBLIC HEALTH REPORTS. Effective with the July 5, 1946, issue, these extracts may be purchased from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C., for 10 cents a single copy. Subscriptions are obtainable at $1.00 per year; $1.25 foreign.

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—ANNOUNCEMENT—

Courses in Laboratory Diagnosis of Tuberculosis

A 2-week course for laboratory directors, senior staff members, and physicians in the laboratory diagnosis of tuberculosis will be given October 4–15 at the Laboratory Division of the Communicable Disease Center. In addition, a 4-week course for laboratory personnel in the laboratory diagnosis of tuberculosis will be offered November 15 to December 10.

Tentative outline for the 2-week course.—The course is designed for laboratory directors, senior laboratory staff members, physicians and other supervising personnel. It consists of demonstrations, lectures and round-table discussions, supplemented by laboratory exercises.

Phases of the program and relative amounts of time allotted to each is as follows:

1. Laboratory personnel protection	2 days
2. Culture media preparation	
3. Microscopy techniques	2 days
4. Interpretation of results and reporting	
5. Culture techniques	2 days
6. Digestion and concentration	
7. Culture diagnosis	2 days
8. Animal inoculation and autopsy	1 day
9. Streptomycin assays	1 day
10. Evaluation studies	

Tentative outline for the 4-week course.—The course is essentially practical laboratory training, enabling the students to carry out the various procedures themselves to insure proficiency. It is supplemented by lectures and demonstrations.

Phases of the program and relative amount of time allotted to each is as follows:

1. Preparation of culture media: Practice in making the commonly used diagnostic and research media	2 days
2. Microscopic techniques: Training in preparation of smears and stains. Interpretation of findings. Fluorescent microscopy	2 days
3. Culture techniques: Training in preparation of cultures. Digestion and concentration methods. Particular emphasis on interpretation of findings. Includes training in identification of types of organisms and their colony morphology	13 days
4. Animal experimentation: Training in techniques of inoculation and autopsy of mice, guinea pigs and rabbits. Tuberculin testing of animals	3 days

This training is open to all grades of employed laboratory personnel. Although first consideration will be given to the laboratories of State and local public health departments, applicants from hospitals and

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